

available in a web version that can be played in the browser, but that requires some setup.

<http://dgit.in/NSyZ9Z>

Mario

If you consider yourself a fan of both Mario and Portal, why the hell do we have to tell you about this game? Imagine if you could play all the classic levels of Mario—and more—but with the a portal gun. Actually don't imagine, just download the game.

stabyourself.net/mario/



Free-to-Play games

Now we come to the aptly named yet somewhat deceptive, Free 2 Play model. Free to play games, as the name suggests, do not cost anything to “play” but a closer look is needed at this genre so you understand what you are getting into.

Yes, you are free to play the game, but remember the common adage, if you aren't paying for the product, you are the product. Of course no sensible developer / publisher will spend tons of money to make a game that will get them nothing in return. So ask your self what are they getting in return?

First of all you will notice that while there is no shortage of these games, none of them are single player. Multiplayer games are more attractive for many people because you are playing with other people and so you have a better challenge. For some it is a matter of pride to be high up in the leaderboards, for others it is a matter of community. Most importantly, single player games have no way of coming back to the developer with money.

The fact is, free to play games with micro transactions or purchasable items often end up giving the developers more revenue than even a straight-up \$60 game would. Of course there are also games that have more of a shareware model, you can play up to a particular level and no more.